

MONTREAL LIGHTS SILVER SPARK

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After several turbulent seasons that saw Mercedes slip down the pecking order — not to mention the departure of Lewis Hamilton, a monumental loss both on and off the track — the team entered the 2025 Formula One season with renewed confidence and improved pace. While still slightly off the benchmark set by the blistering McLaren duo and a relentless Max Verstappen, the Silver Arrows were firmly back in the mix, constantly grabbing points and staying in the fight, if not quite in the spotlight. The numbers paint a picture of a team on the rise. Mercedes has finished in the points in nearly every race this season, with just a handful of blemishes. The only clear blot came in Monaco, where strategic miscalculations left it out of position and scrambling to recover — a rare off-weekend in an otherwise decent campaign.

George Russell (**in pic, left**) has been the clear team leader, doing most of the heavy lifting while allowing his young and upcoming teammate, Kimi Antonelli (**in pic, right**), to come

up to speed with the complexities of F1. In the first nine rounds, the 27-year-old has notched eight top-10 finishes and missed the points just once. He's also brought home four podiums, including a strong second-place finish earlier in the year in Bahrain.

The pace has always been there; what Russell needed was a clean, controlled weekend to fully show what he and the car were capable of. Canada provided exactly that.

Making it count

Returning to a circuit where he'd made headlines a year ago — by taking pole over Verstappen with an identical lap time, simply by crossing the line first — Russell made sure there would be no such fine margins this time. He took pole with a dominant qualifying performance, clearly ousting Verstappen.

On race day, Russell backed it up with a commanding display from the front. He controlled the race from start to finish, keeping Verstappen at bay without ever needing to get defensive, thanks to clinical pace, tyre management, and a car that delivered under pressure when it truly mattered. A late-race Safety Car neutralised the field, but by then, the

job was done. Russell, who had to settle for third a year ago, cruised to his fourth career win — his first since the Las Vegas Grand Prix in November 2024.

While Russell carried the bulk of the team's points, Mercedes also watched with pride

